

AIMLC ZC416 - Mathematical Foundations for Machine Learning

Assignment 1: Linear Systems and Matrix Decompositions

Student Details:

- **Name:** Ashwani Singh
 - **BITS ID:** 2025AC05272
-

Overview of Guidelines

As per the course guidelines and general queries clarifications:

1. **No Built-in Matrix Functions:** All operations for REF, RREF, LU, Cholesky, and QR are implemented completely from scratch using basic Python loops, conditioning, and element-level arithmetic. Libraries like **NumPy** are only used for basic data storage, array indexing, shape inspection, and simple scalar arithmetic.
2. **Aesthetics & Premium Format:** This notebook uses beautiful LaTeX equations, well-formatted console printouts, and clear highlighted instructions for the handwritten submission.
3. **Handwritten Submissions:** Sections marked with 📝 **[HANDWRITTEN SUBMISSION NOTE]** provide structured guidelines and results that you should write down in your final handwritten PDF submission (`BITSID.pdf`).

Core Custom Linear Algebra Utilities

To ensure absolute compliance with the "no built-in functions" instruction, we first define our own utility functions for fundamental operations such as matrix multiplication, transpose, vector norms, and beautiful matrix printing.

```
In [1]: import numpy as np

def custom_mat_mul(A, x):
    """
    Computes matrix-vector multiplication Ax.
    A: 2D numpy array of shape (m, n)
    x: 1D or 2D numpy array of shape (n,) or (n, 1)
    """
    m, n = A.shape
    # Flatten x to 1D if needed for easier indexing
    x_flat = x.flatten()
    res = np.zeros(m)
    for i in range(m):
```

```

        for j in range(n):
            res[i] += A[i, j] * x_flat[j]
        return res if len(x.shape) == 1 else res.reshape(-1, 1)

def custom_mat_mul_mat(A, B):
    """
    Computes matrix-matrix multiplication AB.
    A: shape (m, n)
    B: shape (n, p)
    """
    m, n = A.shape
    n2, p = B.shape
    assert n == n2, "Inner dimensions must match for matrix multiplication"
    res = np.zeros((m, p))
    for i in range(m):
        for j in range(p):
            for k in range(n):
                res[i, j] += A[i, k] * B[k, j]
    return res

def custom_mat_transpose(A):
    """
    Computes the transpose of a matrix A.
    """
    m, n = A.shape
    res = np.zeros((n, m))
    for i in range(m):
        for j in range(n):
            res[j, i] = A[i, j]
    return res

def custom_vector_norm(x):
    """
    Computes the L2 norm of a vector x.
    """
    return np.sqrt(np.sum(x ** 2))

def custom_matrix_norm_frobenius(A):
    """
    Computes the Frobenius norm of a matrix A.
    """
    return np.sqrt(np.sum(A ** 2))

def print_matrix(name, M, decimals=4):
    """
    Prints a matrix M beautifully with rounded float values for readability.
    Cleans up extremely small values near zero.
    """
    print(f"--- {name} ---")
    m, n = M.shape
    for i in range(m):
        row_str = "[ "
        for j in range(n):
            val = M[i, j]
            # Clean up tiny floating point values
            if abs(val) < 1e-12:
                val = 0.0
            row_str += f"{val: .4f} "
        row_str += "]"

```

```
print(row_str)
print()
```

Q1) Finding Solutions of Linear Systems

Mathematical Background & Theory

We are given an underdetermined system of linear equations $Ax = b$, where $A \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times n}$ and $b \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times 1}$ with $m < n$. Since the number of variables (n) exceeds the number of equations (m), the system will either have **infinitely many solutions** (if it is consistent) or **no solution** (if it is inconsistent).

To solve this system, we construct the **augmented matrix** $[A \mid b]$ of size $m \times (n + 1)$. We then apply elementary row operations to reduce $[A \mid b]$ to:

1. Row Echelon Form (REF):

- All non-zero rows are above any rows of all zeros.
- The leading coefficient (pivot) of a non-zero row is strictly to the right of the leading coefficient of the row above it.
- All entries in a column below a leading coefficient are zero.

2. Reduced Row Echelon Form (RREF):

- It is in REF.
- The leading entry in each non-zero row is 1 (normalized pivot).
- Each leading 1 is the only non-zero entry in its column.

Numerical Stability: Partial Pivoting

To avoid division by zero and improve numerical stability, we implement **partial pivoting**. Before eliminating entries below the active element in column j , we scan the rows from the current row i down to $m - 1$ to find the row with the largest absolute value in column j . We swap this row with the active row i before proceeding. If the largest entry in the column is zero (numerically $< 10^{-9}$), it indicates a **free variable** column, and we move to the next column without incrementing our active row.

Q1(a) Custom REF and RREF Code Implementation

```
In [2]: def compute_ref(A, b):
        """
        Constructs the augmented matrix [A | b] and reduces it to Row Echelon
        using Gaussian elimination with partial pivoting.
        Returns the REF augmented matrix and a list of pivot tuples (row, col)
        """
        m, n = A.shape
        # Construct the augmented matrix [A | b]
        M = np.hstack((A.astype(np.float64), b.astype(np.float64).reshape(-1,
        pivot_row = 0
        pivots = []
```

```

for col in range(n):
    if pivot_row >= m:
        break

    # Find the row with maximum absolute entry in active column 'col'
    max_row = pivot_row
    for r in range(pivot_row + 1, m):
        if abs(M[r, col]) > abs(M[max_row, col]):
            max_row = r

    # If pivot value is virtually zero, this is a non-pivot column
    if abs(M[max_row, col]) < 1e-9:
        continue

    # Swap rows to place the largest pivot in the current pivot row
    if max_row != pivot_row:
        # Swap row max_row and pivot_row
        temp = M[pivot_row].copy()
        M[pivot_row] = M[max_row]
        M[max_row] = temp

    pivots.append((pivot_row, col))

    # Eliminate entries below the pivot
    for r in range(pivot_row + 1, m):
        factor = M[r, col] / M[pivot_row, col]
        M[r] = M[r] - factor * M[pivot_row]

    pivot_row += 1

return M, pivots

def compute_rref(A, b):
    """
    Reduces the augmented matrix [A | b] to Reduced Row Echelon Form (RREF)
    Returns the RREF augmented matrix and a list of pivot tuples (row, col)
    """
    # First compute the Row Echelon Form (REF)
    M, pivots = compute_ref(A, b)
    m, n = A.shape

    # Back-substitution: start from the last pivot and eliminate upwards
    for r, c in reversed(pivots):
        # Normalize the pivot row so that the pivot entry becomes exactly 1
        pivot_val = M[r, c]
        M[r] = M[r] / pivot_val

        # Eliminate entries in column 'c' in all rows above the pivot row
        for row in range(r):
            factor = M[row, c]
            M[row] = M[row] - factor * M[r]

    return M, pivots

```

Q1(b) Identifying Pivot Columns, Particular, and Homogeneous Solutions

Once the augmented matrix $[A \mid b]$ is reduced to RREF $[R \mid d]$, we can fully characterize the solution space.

1. Identifying Pivot and Non-Pivot Columns

- **Pivot Columns:** Columns $j \in \{0, \dots, n-1\}$ that contain a leading 1 in RREF. These correspond to the **pivot variables** (dependent variables).
- **Non-Pivot Columns:** All remaining columns in A . These correspond to **free variables** (independent variables), which can take any arbitrary scalar value.

2. Checking Consistency

The system is consistent if and only if there is **no row** in RREF $[R \mid d]$ that has all zeros in the coefficient part but a non-zero value in the augmented column d .

Mathematically, if there is a row index r such that $R[r, j] = 0$ for all $j = 0, \dots, n-1$ but $d[r] \neq 0$, the system is **inconsistent** (equivalent to $0 = 1$), and no solution exists.

3. Particular Solution (x_p)

To find a particular solution $x_p \in \mathbb{R}^n$, we exploit the free variables. We set **all free variables to 0**. Then, for each pivot variable x_c associated with the pivot (r, c) in our pivots list, the equation in row r simplifies directly to:

$$x_c = d[r]$$

Thus, x_p is a vector where:

- $x_p[c] = d[r]$ for each pivot (r, c) .
- $x_p[j] = 0$ for all free column indices j .

4. Homogeneous Solutions ($Ax = 0$)

The solutions to $Ax = 0$ represent the null space (kernel) of A . Since there are k pivots, there are $d = n - k$ free variables. To construct a basis $\{v_1, \dots, v_d\}$ for the homogeneous solution space: For each free variable column $f \in \text{free_cols}$, we construct a basis vector v_f by:

1. Setting $x_f = 1$.
2. Setting all other free variables $j \in \text{free_cols} \setminus \{f\}$ to 0.
3. Solving for the pivot variables in RREF using $Rx = 0$: For each pivot (r, c) , we have:

$$x_c + \sum_{j \in \text{free_cols}} R[r, j] x_j = 0 \implies x_c = -R[r, f]$$

Hence, each null space basis vector $v_f \in \mathbb{R}^n$ is constructed as:

- $v_f[f] = 1.0$.
- $v_f[j] = 0.0$ for all other free columns $j \neq f$.

- $v_f[c] = -R[r, f]$ for each pivot (r, c) .

Q1(b) Solution Space Analysis Implementation

```
In [3]: def analyze_solution_space(A, b):
        """
        Solves  $Ax = b$  by computing RREF and extracting pivot/free columns,
        particular solution, and homogeneous null space basis.
        """
        m, n = A.shape
        M, pivots = compute_rref(A, b)

        # Separate R (coefficient part) and d (augmented column)
        R = M[:, :n]
        d = M[:, n]

        # Check for consistency
        is_consistent = True
        for r in range(m):
            all_zeros = True
            for c in range(n):
                if abs(R[r, c]) > 1e-9:
                    all_zeros = False
                    break
            if all_zeros and abs(d[r]) > 1e-9:
                is_consistent = False
                break

        if not is_consistent:
            return {
                "consistent": False,
                "RREF": M,
                "pivots": pivots,
                "pivot_cols": [c for r, c in pivots],
                "free_cols": [c for c in range(n) if c not in [p[1] for p in pivots]],
                "particular_sol": None,
                "homogeneous_basis": []
            }

        # Identify pivot columns and free columns
        pivot_cols = [c for r, c in pivots]
        free_cols = [c for c in range(n) if c not in pivot_cols]

        # 1. Compute particular solution  $x_p$ 
        x_p = np.zeros(n)
        for r, c in pivots:
            x_p[c] = d[r]

        # 2. Compute basis vectors for homogeneous solution  $Ax = 0$ 
        homogeneous_basis = []
        for f in free_cols:
            v = np.zeros(n)
            v[f] = 1.0
            for r, c in pivots:
                # In  $Ax = 0$ , the pivot variable  $x_c = -R[r, f] * x_f$ 
                v[c] = -R[r, f]
            homogeneous_basis.append(v)
```

```

return {
    "consistent": True,
    "RREF": M,
    "pivots": pivots,
    "pivot_cols": pivot_cols,
    "free_cols": free_cols,
    "particular_sol": x_p,
    "homogeneous_basis": homogeneous_basis
}

```

Q1(c) Randomized System Generation, Solution, and Verification

Now we construct a random 6×9 matrix A and a suitable vector b . To ensure that the system is **guaranteed to be consistent**, we:

1. Generate $A \in \mathbb{R}^{6 \times 9}$ using random integers in $[-5, 5]$.
2. Generate a random true solution $x_{\text{true}} \in \mathbb{R}^{9 \times 1}$ of integers in $[-3, 3]$.
3. Compute the consistent vector $b = Ax_{\text{true}}$ using our custom matrix multiplication.

We then solve this system and verify the **general solution**:

$$x_{\text{general}} = x_p + \sum_{i=1}^d c_i v_i$$

by picking random constants c_i and verifying that $Ax_{\text{general}} \approx b$ and $Av_i \approx 0$ for all null space vectors.

[HANDWRITTEN SUBMISSION NOTE]

For your handwritten PDF assignment submission (`BITSID.pdf`), you should write:

1. **Random Matrix A & Vector b :** Copy the printed random matrix A and vector b from the cell output below.
2. **REF and RREF Matrices:** Write down the computed Augmented Row Echelon Form (REF) and Reduced Row Echelon Form (RREF) matrices.
3. **Pivot Analysis:** List the identified Pivot Columns (associated with leading 1s) and Free Columns (associated with free variables).
4. **Solution Formulation:** Write down the particular solution x_p and the basis vectors $\{v_1, v_2, v_3\}$ for the homogeneous system $Ax = 0$.
5. **General Solution:** Express the general solution as $x = x_p + c_1 v_1 + c_2 v_2 + c_3 v_3$.
6. **Verification Statement:** State that the custom code verified the general solution by showing that $Ax_p \approx b$ and $Av_i \approx 0$, reporting the numerical residual errors printed below.

Q1(c) Executing Randomized 6×9 Linear System Solution

```
In [4]: # Seed for reproducibility of random generation in this run
np.random.seed(42)

# 1. Generate a random 6 x 9 matrix A with integer entries in [-5, 5]
A_rand = np.random.randint(-5, 6, size=(6, 9))

# 2. Generate a random 9-dimensional true solution vector with integers i
x_true = np.random.randint(-3, 4, size=9)

# 3. Compute consistent vector b = A * x_true using custom matrix-vector
b_rand = custom_mat_mul(A_rand, x_true)

# 4. Print inputs
print_matrix("Random Matrix A (6 x 9)", A_rand)
print("Random consistent target vector b:")
print(b_rand)
print()

# 5. Perform solution analysis
analysis = analyze_solution_space(A_rand, b_rand)

# 6. Print REF & RREF
ref_M, _ = compute_ref(A_rand, b_rand)
print_matrix("Augmented Matrix [A | b] in Row Echelon Form (REF)", ref_M)
print_matrix("Augmented Matrix [A | b] in Reduced Row Echelon Form (RREF)", ref_M)

# 7. Print Pivot & Free Columns
print(f"Pivot Columns (0-indexed): {analysis['pivot_cols']}")
print(f"Free Columns (0-indexed): {analysis['free_cols']}")
print()

# 8. Print Particular Solution
x_p = analysis["particular_sol"]
print("Particular Solution x_p:")
print(x_p)
print()

# 9. Print Homogeneous Solutions (Null Space Basis)
basis = analysis["homogeneous_basis"]
print(f"Homogeneous Solution Space Dimension (Nullity) = {len(basis)}")
for idx, v in enumerate(basis):
    print(f"Null Space Basis Vector v_{idx+1}:")
    print(v)
print()

# 10. Construct General Solution & Verify
print("---- GENERAL SOLUTION VERIFICATION ----")
# Pick arbitrary constants c_i
c_coeffs = [2.5, -1.2, 0.8] # Rank = 6, Free variables = 3
print(f"Choosing arbitrary free variables coefficients: c = {c_coeffs}")

x_gen = x_p.copy()
for i, coeff in enumerate(c_coeffs):
    x_gen += coeff * basis[i]

print("Constructed General Solution x_general:")
```



```

print(x_gen)
print()

# Verify  $A * x_{general} = b$ 
A_x_gen = custom_mat_mul(A_rand, x_gen)
residual_xp = custom_vector_norm(custom_mat_mul(A_rand, x_p) - b_rand)
residual_gen = custom_vector_norm(A_x_gen - b_rand)
print(f"Particular solution residual  $\|A*x_p - b\|_2 = \{residual\_xp:.4e\}")
print(f"General solution residual  $\|A*x_{gen} - b\|_2 = \{residual\_gen:.4e\}")

# Verify  $A * v_i = 0$  for each basis vector
for i, v in enumerate(basis):
    residual_vi = custom_vector_norm(custom_mat_mul(A_rand, v))
    print(f"Homogeneous basis vector  $v_{\{i+1\}}$  residual  $\|A*v_{\{i+1\}}\|_2 = \{$$$ 
```

```

--- Random Matrix A (6 x 9) ---
[ 1.0000 -2.0000  5.0000  2.0000 -1.0000  1.0000  4.0000 -3.0000
1.0000 ]
[ 5.0000  5.0000  2.0000 -1.0000 -2.0000  2.0000  2.0000 -3.0000
0.0000 ]
[ -1.0000 -4.0000  2.0000  0.0000 -4.0000 -1.0000 -5.0000  4.0000
0.0000 ]
[ 3.0000 -5.0000  5.0000  5.0000  4.0000 -3.0000  1.0000 -2.0000
3.0000 ]
[ -3.0000 -1.0000 -3.0000  1.0000 -1.0000  3.0000  1.0000 -4.0000
-2.0000 ]
[ 3.0000 -4.0000  4.0000  3.0000  4.0000 -1.0000 -4.0000 -2.0000
1.0000 ]

```

Random consistent target vector b:
[12. 8. -11. 26. -14. 20.]

```

--- Augmented Matrix [A | b] in Row Echelon Form (REF) ---
[ 5.0000  5.0000  2.0000 -1.0000 -2.0000  2.0000  2.0000 -3.0000
0.0000  8.0000 ]
[ 0.0000 -8.0000  3.8000  5.6000  5.2000 -4.2000 -0.2000 -0.2000
3.0000  21.2000 ]
[ 0.0000  0.0000  3.1750  0.1000 -2.5500  2.1750  3.6750 -2.3250
-0.1250  2.4500 ]
[ 0.0000  0.0000  0.0000 -2.3307 -5.5669  0.3071 -5.6535  4.1890
-1.0866 -18.1024 ]
[ 0.0000  0.0000  0.0000  0.0000 -5.9459  3.9730 -1.2973 -3.1892
-2.1351 -17.4324 ]
[ 0.0000  0.0000  0.0000  0.0000  0.0000  3.8665 -2.0227 -4.4830
-2.2301 -2.6335 ]

```

```

--- Augmented Matrix [A | b] in Reduced Row Echelon Form (RREF) ---
[ 1.0000  0.0000  0.0000  0.0000  0.0000  0.0000 -2.1533  0.0553
-0.1974 -0.1105 ]
[ 0.0000  1.0000  0.0000  0.0000  0.0000  0.0000  2.7136 -0.5286
0.3800  2.0572 ]
[ 0.0000  0.0000  1.0000  0.0000  0.0000  0.0000  1.3262 -0.0860
0.3204  3.1719 ]
[ 0.0000  0.0000  0.0000  1.0000  0.0000  0.0000  2.6705 -1.3807
0.4530  1.7615 ]
[ 0.0000  0.0000  0.0000  0.0000  1.0000  0.0000 -0.1314 -0.2384
-0.0263  2.4767 ]
[ 0.0000  0.0000  0.0000  0.0000  0.0000  1.0000 -0.5231 -1.1594
-0.5768 -0.6811 ]

```

Pivot Columns (0-indexed): [0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5]
Free Columns (0-indexed): [6, 7, 8]

Particular Solution x_p :
[-0.11050698 2.05716385 3.1719324 1.7614989 2.4767083 -0.68111683
0. 0. 0.]

Homogeneous Solution Space Dimension (Nullity) = 3

Null Space Basis Vector v_1 :
[2.15326965 -2.71359295 -1.32623071 -2.67053637 0.13137399 0.52314475
1. 0. 0.]

Null Space Basis Vector v_2 :
[-0.05525349 0.52858193 0.0859662 1.38074945 0.23835415 1.15944159
0. 1. 0.]

Null Space Basis Vector v_3 :

```
[ 0.19735489 -0.3800147 -0.32035268 -0.45304923  0.02630419  0.57678178
 0.          0.          1.          ]
```

--- GENERAL SOLUTION VERIFICATION ---

Choosing arbitrary free variables coefficients: $c = [2.5, -1.2, 0.8]$

Constructed General Solution x_{general} :

```
[ 5.49685525 -5.66512858 -0.50308597 -6.93418075  2.54016165 -0.30315944
 2.5         -1.2         0.8         ]
```

Particular solution residual $\|A \cdot x_p - b\|_2 = 6.6465e-15$

General solution residual $\|A \cdot x_{\text{gen}} - b\|_2 = 1.4431e-14$

Homogeneous basis vector v_1 residual $\|A \cdot v_1\|_2 = 2.6668e-15$

Homogeneous basis vector v_2 residual $\|A \cdot v_2\|_2 = 2.0351e-15$

Homogeneous basis vector v_3 residual $\|A \cdot v_3\|_2 = 9.4857e-16$

Q2) Matrix Decompositions

Matrix decompositions factorize a matrix into a product of simpler matrices, which are easier to work with, invert, or analyze. In this section, we implement three major decompositions entirely from scratch:

1. **LU Decomposition:** Factorizes $A = LU$ using elementary row operations and their corresponding elementary matrices.
2. **Cholesky Decomposition:** Factorizes a symmetric positive definite matrix $A = LL^T$.
3. **QR Decomposition:** Factorizes an $m \times n$ matrix A ($m > n$) with linearly independent columns into $A = QR$ using the Gram-Schmidt process.

Q2(a) LU Decomposition using Elementary Matrices

Theory & Mathematical Derivation

LU decomposition factorizes a square matrix $A \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times n}$ into a lower triangular matrix L (with 1s on the diagonal) and an upper triangular matrix U .

For a **symmetric and positive definite** matrix A , Gaussian elimination can always be completed **without row swaps** (no pivoting required). The row elimination process of converting A to an upper triangular matrix U can be written as a sequence of elementary row operations. Specifically, to eliminate the entry in row i , column j (where $i > j$), we perform the operation:

$$R_i \leftarrow R_i - l_{ij}R_j \quad \text{where } l_{ij} = \frac{A[i, j]}{A[j, j]}$$

This row operation is mathematically equivalent to multiplying A on the left by an **elementary matrix** E_{ij} . The elementary matrix E_{ij} is formed by taking the identity matrix I_n and replacing the entry at row i , column j with $-l_{ij}$:

$$E_{ij} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & & & & \\ & \ddots & & & \\ & & 1 & & \\ & & -l_{ij} & \ddots & \\ & & & & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

If there are k elimination steps, the final upper triangular matrix U is:

$$E_k E_{k-1} \dots E_1 A = U$$

To reconstruct A , we multiply both sides by the inverses of the elementary matrices in reverse order:

$$A = (E_1^{-1} E_2^{-1} \dots E_k^{-1}) U = LU$$

Where each **inverse elementary matrix** E_{ij}^{-1} is simply I_n with the sign of the multiplier reversed ($+l_{ij}$ instead of $-l_{ij}$):

$$E_{ij}^{-1} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & & & & \\ & \ddots & & & \\ & & 1 & & \\ & & l_{ij} & \ddots & \\ & & & & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

The lower triangular matrix L is computed as the sequential product of these inverse elementary matrices:

$$L = E_1^{-1} E_2^{-1} \dots E_k^{-1}$$

Since we are performing the operations in a nested column-by-column loop, this product L is exactly lower triangular with the multipliers l_{ij} at row i , column j and 1s on the diagonal.



[HANDWRITTEN SUBMISSION NOTE]

For your handwritten PDF assignment submission ([BITSID.pdf](#)), you should write:

1. **Matrix A :** Write down the symmetric positive definite matrix A generated below.
2. **Elementary Matrices:** Show how the elementary matrices E_{ij} are constructed for each row operation (with 1s on the diagonal and the negative multiplier at row i , column j). Provide a sample E_{ij} and E_{ij}^{-1} .
3. **Sequence of Operations:** Write down the sequence of operations that yields L and U .

4. **Decomposition Result:** Write down the final lower triangular matrix L and upper triangular matrix U .
5. **Verification Proof:** Show that multiplying L and U reconstructs A exactly ($LU = A$).

Q2(a) Custom LU Decomposition with Elementary Matrices Implementation

```
In [5]: def lu_decomposition_elementary(A_orig):
        """
        Computes the LU decomposition of a square matrix A using elementary matrices.
        Returns L, U, list of elementary matrices, and list of inverse elementary matrices.
        """
        n = A_orig.shape[0]
        # Initialize U as a copy of A, and L as the identity matrix
        U = A_orig.copy().astype(np.float64)
        L = np.eye(n)

        elementary_matrices = []
        inverse_elementary_matrices = []

        # Run Gaussian elimination column by column
        for j in range(n):
            for i in range(j + 1, n):
                if abs(U[j, j]) < 1e-9:
                    raise ValueError("Zero pivot encountered. LU decomposition failed.")

                # Calculate multiplier l_ij
                multiplier = U[i, j] / U[j, j]

                # Construct the elementary matrix E_ij
                E_ij = np.eye(n)
                E_ij[i, j] = -multiplier
                elementary_matrices.append((i, j, E_ij))

                # Construct the inverse elementary matrix E_ij_inv
                E_ij_inv = np.eye(n)
                E_ij_inv[i, j] = multiplier
                inverse_elementary_matrices.append((i, j, E_ij_inv))

                # Apply row operation to U: U = E_ij * U using custom matrix multiplication
                U = custom_mat_mul_mat(E_ij, U)

                # Accumulate inverse elementary matrix into L: L = L * E_ij_inv
                L = custom_mat_mul_mat(L, E_ij_inv)

        return L, U, elementary_matrices, inverse_elementary_matrices

# --- Test and Verification of Q2(a) ---
np.random.seed(15)

# 1. Construct a symmetric and positive definite matrix A of size 4 x 4
# B is a random matrix, A = B * B^T is guaranteed symmetric positive semi-definite
# We add 4*I to ensure it is strictly positive definite and has clean integers
B = np.random.randint(1, 4, size=(4, 4))
A_sym = custom_mat_mul_mat(B, custom_mat_transpose(B)) + 4 * np.eye(4)
```

```

print_matrix("Symmetric & Positive Definite Matrix A (4 x 4)", A_sym)

# 2. Perform LU Decomposition with elementary matrices
L, U, E_list, E_inv_list = lu_decomposition_elementary(A_sym)

# 3. Print the generated elementary matrices
print("=== GENERATION OF ELEMENTARY MATRICES ===")
for idx, (i, j, E_ij) in enumerate(E_list):
    print(f"Step {idx+1}: Eliminate element at ({i+1},{j+1}) using pivot")
    print(f"Row Operation: R_{i+1} <- R_{i+1} - ({A_sym[i,j]/A_sym[j,j]}:.")
    print_matrix(f"Elementary Matrix E_{i+1}{j+1}", E_ij)
    print_matrix(f"Inverse Elementary Matrix E_{i+1}{j+1}^{(-1)", E_inv_li
    print("-" * 40)
print()

# 4. Print final lower L and upper U matrices
print_matrix("Lower Triangular Matrix L", L)
print_matrix("Upper Triangular Matrix U", U)

# 5. Verification of A = LU
LU_product = custom_mat_mul_mat(L, U)
print_matrix("Reconstructed Matrix L * U", LU_product)
error_lu = custom_matrix_norm_frobenius(A_sym - LU_product)
print(f"Reconstruction Error ||A - L*U||_F = {error_lu:.4e}")

```

--- Symmetric & Positive Definite Matrix A (4 x 4) ---

```
[ 14.0000  11.0000  10.0000  14.0000 ]
[ 11.0000  19.0000  11.0000  14.0000 ]
[ 10.0000  11.0000  17.0000  16.0000 ]
[ 14.0000  14.0000  16.0000  27.0000 ]
```

=== GENERATION OF ELEMENTARY MATRICES ===

Step 1: Eliminate element at (2,1) using pivot at (1,1)

Row Operation: $R_2 \leftarrow R_2 - (0.7857) * R_1$

--- Elementary Matrix E_{21} ---

```
[ 1.0000  0.0000  0.0000  0.0000 ]
[ -0.7857  1.0000  0.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 0.0000  0.0000  1.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 0.0000  0.0000  0.0000  1.0000 ]
```

--- Inverse Elementary Matrix $E_{21}^{(-1)}$ ---

```
[ 1.0000  0.0000  0.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 0.7857  1.0000  0.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 0.0000  0.0000  1.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 0.0000  0.0000  0.0000  1.0000 ]
```

Step 2: Eliminate element at (3,1) using pivot at (1,1)

Row Operation: $R_3 \leftarrow R_3 - (0.7143) * R_1$

--- Elementary Matrix E_{31} ---

```
[ 1.0000  0.0000  0.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 0.0000  1.0000  0.0000  0.0000 ]
[ -0.7143  0.0000  1.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 0.0000  0.0000  0.0000  1.0000 ]
```

--- Inverse Elementary Matrix $E_{31}^{(-1)}$ ---

```
[ 1.0000  0.0000  0.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 0.0000  1.0000  0.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 0.7143  0.0000  1.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 0.0000  0.0000  0.0000  1.0000 ]
```

Step 3: Eliminate element at (4,1) using pivot at (1,1)

Row Operation: $R_4 \leftarrow R_4 - (1.0000) * R_1$

--- Elementary Matrix E_{41} ---

```
[ 1.0000  0.0000  0.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 0.0000  1.0000  0.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 0.0000  0.0000  1.0000  0.0000 ]
[ -1.0000  0.0000  0.0000  1.0000 ]
```

--- Inverse Elementary Matrix $E_{41}^{(-1)}$ ---

```
[ 1.0000  0.0000  0.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 0.0000  1.0000  0.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 0.0000  0.0000  1.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 1.0000  0.0000  0.0000  1.0000 ]
```

Step 4: Eliminate element at (3,2) using pivot at (2,2)

Row Operation: $R_3 \leftarrow R_3 - (0.5789) * R_2$

--- Elementary Matrix E_{32} ---

```
[ 1.0000  0.0000  0.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 0.0000  1.0000  0.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 0.0000 -0.3034  1.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 0.0000  0.0000  0.0000  1.0000 ]
```

```

--- Inverse Elementary Matrix E_32^(-1) ---
[ 1.0000  0.0000  0.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 0.0000  1.0000  0.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 0.0000  0.3034  1.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 0.0000  0.0000  0.0000  1.0000 ]

```

Step 5: Eliminate element at (4,2) using pivot at (2,2)

Row Operation: $R_4 \leftarrow R_4 - (0.7368) * R_2$

```

--- Elementary Matrix E_42 ---
[ 1.0000  0.0000  0.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 0.0000  1.0000  0.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 0.0000  0.0000  1.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 0.0000 -0.2897  0.0000  1.0000 ]

```

```

--- Inverse Elementary Matrix E_42^(-1) ---

```

```

[ 1.0000  0.0000  0.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 0.0000  1.0000  0.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 0.0000  0.0000  1.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 0.0000  0.2897  0.0000  1.0000 ]

```

Step 6: Eliminate element at (4,3) using pivot at (3,3)

Row Operation: $R_4 \leftarrow R_4 - (0.9412) * R_3$

```

--- Elementary Matrix E_43 ---
[ 1.0000  0.0000  0.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 0.0000  1.0000  0.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 0.0000  0.0000  1.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 0.0000  0.0000 -0.5716  1.0000 ]

```

```

--- Inverse Elementary Matrix E_43^(-1) ---

```

```

[ 1.0000  0.0000  0.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 0.0000  1.0000  0.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 0.0000  0.0000  1.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 0.0000  0.0000  0.5716  1.0000 ]

```

```

--- Lower Triangular Matrix L ---

```

```

[ 1.0000  0.0000  0.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 0.7857  1.0000  0.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 0.7143  0.3034  1.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 1.0000  0.2897  0.5716  1.0000 ]

```

```

--- Upper Triangular Matrix U ---

```

```

[ 14.0000  11.0000  10.0000  14.0000 ]
[ 0.0000  10.3571  3.1429  3.0000 ]
[ 0.0000  0.0000  8.9034  5.0897 ]
[ 0.0000  0.0000  0.0000  9.2215 ]

```

```

--- Reconstructed Matrix L * U ---

```

```

[ 14.0000  11.0000  10.0000  14.0000 ]
[ 11.0000  19.0000  11.0000  14.0000 ]
[ 10.0000  11.0000  17.0000  16.0000 ]
[ 14.0000  14.0000  16.0000  27.0000 ]

```

Reconstruction Error $\|A - L*U\|_F = 0.0000e+00$

Q2(b) Cholesky's Decomposition

Theory & Algorithm

Cholesky decomposition factorizes a symmetric and positive definite matrix

$A \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times n}$ into:

$$A = L_{\text{chol}} L_{\text{chol}}^T$$

where L_{chol} is a lower triangular matrix with **strictly positive diagonal elements**.

We implement the **Cholesky-Banachiewicz algorithm**, which solves for the elements of L_{chol} row-by-row using the following formulas:

1. For diagonal elements ($i = j$):

$$L_{ii} = \sqrt{A_{ii} - \sum_{k=0}^{i-1} L_{ik}^2}$$

2. For off-diagonal elements ($i > j$):

$$L_{ij} = \frac{1}{L_{jj}} \left(A_{ij} - \sum_{k=0}^{j-1} L_{ik} L_{jk} \right)$$

Since A is symmetric and positive definite, the value inside the square root for L_{ii} is guaranteed to be strictly positive (> 0), ensuring a real and unique lower triangular matrix.



[HANDWRITTEN SUBMISSION NOTE]

For your handwritten PDF assignment submission (**BITSID.pdf**), you should write:

1. **Cholesky Formula:** State the equations for L_{ii} and L_{ij} .
2. **Cholesky Factor:** Write down the computed lower triangular Cholesky factor L_{chol} for the matrix A from Q2(a).
3. **Verification:** Show that $L_{\text{chol}} L_{\text{chol}}^T = A$ by multiplying the matrices.

Q2(b) Custom Cholesky Decomposition Implementation

```
In [6]: def cholesky_decomposition(A):  
        """  
        Computes the Cholesky decomposition of a symmetric positive definite  
        Returns L_chol such that A = L_chol * L_chol^T.  
        """  
        n = A.shape[0]  
        L_chol = np.zeros((n, n))  
  
        for i in range(n):  
            for j in range(i + 1):  
                # Sum up terms L[i,k]*L[j,k]  
                sum_k = 0.0
```

```

        for k in range(j):
            sum_k += L_chol[i, k] * L_chol[j, k]

        if i == j:
            val = A[i, i] - sum_k
            if val < 0:
                raise ValueError("Matrix is not positive definite!")
            L_chol[i, j] = np.sqrt(val)
        else:
            L_chol[i, j] = (A[i, j] - sum_k) / L_chol[j, j]

    return L_chol

# --- Test and Verification of Q2(b) ---
# We use the same symmetric positive definite matrix A_sym from Q2(a)
L_chol = cholesky_decomposition(A_sym)

print_matrix("Lower Triangular Cholesky Factor L_chol", L_chol)

# Verification: A = L_chol * L_chol^T
L_chol_T = custom_mat_transpose(L_chol)
L_LL_T = custom_mat_mul_mat(L_chol, L_chol_T)
print_matrix("Reconstructed Matrix L_chol * L_chol^T", L_LL_T)

error_cholesky = custom_matrix_norm_frobenius(A_sym - L_LL_T)
print(f"Cholesky Reconstruction Error ||A - L*L^T||_F = {error_cholesky:.

```

--- Lower Triangular Cholesky Factor L_chol ---

```

[ 3.7417  0.0000  0.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 2.9399  3.2183  0.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 2.6726  0.9766  2.9839  0.0000 ]
[ 3.7417  0.9322  1.7057  3.0367 ]

```

--- Reconstructed Matrix L_chol * L_chol^T ---

```

[ 14.0000  11.0000  10.0000  14.0000 ]
[ 11.0000  19.0000  11.0000  14.0000 ]
[ 10.0000  11.0000  17.0000  16.0000 ]
[ 14.0000  14.0000  16.0000  27.0000 ]

```

Cholesky Reconstruction Error ||A - L*L^T||_F = 0.0000e+00

Q2(c) QR Decomposition

Theory & Gram-Schmidt Process

Given n linearly independent vectors in m -dimensional space (arranged as the columns of an $m \times n$ matrix A with $m > n$), we can decompose A into:

$$A = QR$$

where:

- $Q \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times n}$ has **orthonormal columns** ($Q^T Q = I_n$).
- $R \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times n}$ is an **upper triangular matrix**.

We implement the **Modified Gram-Schmidt (MGS)** algorithm. Compared to the classical Gram-Schmidt (CGS) algorithm, MGS is numerically far more stable under

floating-point arithmetic because it updates the remaining un-normalized columns immediately as soon as a new orthonormal basis vector is computed.

Modified Gram-Schmidt Algorithm

Let the columns of A be $a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n$.

1. For $j = 0, 1, \dots, n - 1$:
 - Set $v_j = a_j$.
2. For $j = 0, 1, \dots, n - 1$:
 - Compute the norm of the current column: $R_{jj} = \|v_j\|_2 = \sqrt{\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} v_{j,k}^2}$.
 - Normalize column j to get the j -th orthonormal vector: $q_j = v_j / R_{jj}$.
 - For all subsequent columns $i = j + 1, \dots, n - 1$:
 - Compute the projection of column i onto q_j : $R_{ji} = q_j^T v_i$.
 - Subtract the projection immediately to orthogonalize: $v_i \leftarrow v_i - R_{ji} q_j$.

This process constructs $Q = [q_1 \ q_2 \ \dots \ q_n]$ and the upper triangular matrix R element-by-element.



[HANDWRITTEN SUBMISSION NOTE]

For your handwritten PDF assignment submission (**BITSID.pdf**), you should write:

1. **QR Mathematical Formulation:** Explain the Gram-Schmidt orthogonalization process.
2. **QR Code Snippet:** Paste the screenshots of `qr_decomposition` from the cell below.
3. **Sample Matrix & Result:** Write down a sample matrix A and its decomposed components Q and R .

Q2(c) Custom QR Decomposition Implementation

```
In [7]: def qr_decomposition(A):  
    """  
    Computes the QR decomposition of an m x n matrix A (m >= n)  
    having linearly independent columns using the Modified Gram-Schmidt (  
    Returns Q (m x n) with orthonormal columns, and R (n x n) upper trian  
    """  
    m, n = A.shape  
    Q = np.zeros((m, n))  
    R = np.zeros((n, n))  
  
    # Create a working copy of A's columns  
    V = A.copy().astype(np.float64)  
  
    for j in range(n):  
        # 1. Compute R[j, j] as the L2 norm of the active orthogonal vect  
        norm_v = 0.0  
        for k in range(m):  
            norm_v += V[k, j] ** 2
```

```

    norm_v = np.sqrt(norm_v)

    R[j, j] = norm_v
    if norm_v < 1e-9:
        raise ValueError("Columns are not linearly independent! QR ca

# 2. Compute the j-th column of Q
Q[:, j] = V[:, j] / norm_v

# 3. Orthogonalize the remaining columns with respect to q_j
for i in range(j + 1, n):
    # R[j, i] = q_j^T * v_i
    dot_product = 0.0
    for k in range(m):
        dot_product += Q[k, j] * V[k, i]
    R[j, i] = dot_product

    # Subtract the projection: v_i <- v_i - R[j, i] * q_j
    V[:, i] = V[:, i] - R[j, i] * Q[:, j]

return Q, R

# --- Test and Verification of Q2(c) ---
np.random.seed(5)
# Construct a small 5 x 3 matrix with linearly independent columns
A_test_qr = np.random.randint(-3, 4, size=(5, 3)).astype(np.float64)

Q_t, R_t = qr_decomposition(A_test_qr)
print_matrix("Input Matrix A (5 x 3)", A_test_qr)
print_matrix("Orthogonal Matrix Q (5 x 3)", Q_t)
print_matrix("Upper Triangular Matrix R (3 x 3)", R_t)

# Verify QR = A
QR_reconstructed = custom_mat_mul_mat(Q_t, R_t)
print_matrix("Reconstructed Matrix Q * R", QR_reconstructed)
error_qr = custom_matrix_norm_frobenius(A_test_qr - QR_reconstructed)
print(f"Reconstruction Error ||A - Q*R||_F = {error_qr:.4e}")

# Verify Q^T * Q = I
QT_Q = custom_mat_mul_mat(custom_mat_transpose(Q_t), Q_t)
print_matrix("Orthogonality Check Q^T * Q", QT_Q)
error_ortho = custom_matrix_norm_frobenius(QT_Q - np.eye(3))
print(f"Orthogonality Error ||Q^T*Q - I||_F = {error_ortho:.4e}")

```

```

--- Input Matrix A (5 x 3) ---
[ 0.0000  3.0000  2.0000 ]
[ 3.0000  3.0000 -3.0000 ]
[ -2.0000 -3.0000  1.0000 ]
[ 3.0000  0.0000 -3.0000 ]
[ 3.0000 -3.0000  1.0000 ]

--- Orthogonal Matrix Q (5 x 3) ---
[ 0.0000  0.5083  0.6722 ]
[ 0.5388  0.4099 -0.2585 ]
[ -0.3592 -0.4427 -0.1416 ]
[ 0.5388 -0.0984 -0.3912 ]
[ 0.5388 -0.6066  0.5553 ]

--- Upper Triangular Matrix R (3 x 3) ---
[ 5.5678  1.0776 -3.0533 ]
[ 0.0000  5.9024 -0.9673 ]
[ 0.0000  0.0000  3.7070 ]

--- Reconstructed Matrix Q * R ---
[ 0.0000  3.0000  2.0000 ]
[ 3.0000  3.0000 -3.0000 ]
[ -2.0000 -3.0000  1.0000 ]
[ 3.0000  0.0000 -3.0000 ]
[ 3.0000 -3.0000  1.0000 ]

Reconstruction Error ||A - Q*R||_F = 4.4409e-16
--- Orthogonality Check Q^T * Q ---
[ 1.0000  0.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 0.0000  1.0000  0.0000 ]
[ 0.0000  0.0000  1.0000 ]

Orthogonality Error ||Q^T*Q - I||_F = 1.7554e-16

```

Q2(d) Randomized 7×5 QR Decomposition & Analysis of R Diagonal

Now, we generate a random 7×5 matrix A having linearly independent columns and decompose it into Q and R . Since the matrix is random and $m > n$ ($7 > 5$), its columns are linearly independent with probability 1. We run

`qr_decomposition(A)` to obtain Q and R , output their entries, and focus specifically on the diagonal elements of R (R_{ii} for $i = 0, \dots, 4$).



[HANDWRITTEN SUBMISSION NOTE]

For your handwritten PDF assignment submission (`BITSID.pdf`), you should write:

1. **Random Matrix A :** Copy the printed random 7×5 matrix A and its QR factors printed below.
2. **Diagonal Elements of R :** List the printed diagonal elements R_{ii} ($R_{11}, R_{22}, R_{33}, R_{44}, R_{55}$).
3. **Crucial Observations:** Write down the following detailed observations:

- **Observation 1 (Positivity):** All diagonal elements of R are strictly positive ($R_{ii} > 0$). In this specific run, they are strictly positive numbers.
- **Observation 2 (Geometric Meaning):** In the Gram-Schmidt process, the diagonal element R_{ii} represents the Euclidean (L_2) norm of the i -th column vector a_i after projecting out its components along all preceding orthonormal basis vectors $q_1, \dots, q_{i-1}$:

$$R_{ii} = \|v_i\|_2 \quad \text{where } v_i = a_i - \sum_{k=0}^{i-1} (q_k^T a_i) q_k$$

Geometrically, R_{ii} is the **perpendicular distance** of the column vector a_i to the subspace spanned by the previous $i - 1$ columns. Since the columns of A are **linearly independent**, no column a_i lies in the span of the preceding columns. Thus, the orthogonal residual vector v_i is never the zero vector, which mathematically guarantees that its norm $R_{ii} = \|v_i\|_2$ is strictly positive ($R_{ii} > 0$).

Q2(d) Execution and Verification on a Random 7×5 Matrix

```
In [8]: np.random.seed(99)

# 1. Generate a random 7 x 5 matrix with floating-point entries in [-2.0, 2.0]
A_7x5 = np.random.uniform(-2.0, 2.0, size=(7, 5))

# 2. Perform QR Decomposition
Q_7x5, R_7x5 = qr_decomposition(A_7x5)

# 3. Print inputs and outputs
print_matrix("Random Matrix A (7 x 5)", A_7x5)
print_matrix("Orthogonal Matrix Q (7 x 5)", Q_7x5)
print_matrix("Upper Triangular Matrix R (5 x 5)", R_7x5)

# 4. Focus on diagonal elements of R
print("=== DIAGONAL ELEMENTS OF R ===")
diag_R = []
for i in range(5):
    val = R_7x5[i, i]
    diag_R.append(val)
    print(f"R_{i+1}{i+1} = {val:.6f}")
print()

# 5. Verification
QR_7x5_rec = custom_mat_mul_mat(Q_7x5, R_7x5)
error_rec_7x5 = custom_matrix_norm_frobenius(A_7x5 - QR_7x5_rec)
print(f"Reconstruction Error ||A - Q*R||_F = {error_rec_7x5:.4e}")

QT_Q_7x5 = custom_mat_mul_mat(custom_mat_transpose(Q_7x5), Q_7x5)
error_ortho_7x5 = custom_matrix_norm_frobenius(QT_Q_7x5 - np.eye(5))
print(f"Orthogonality Error ||Q^T*Q - I||_F = {error_ortho_7x5:.4e}")
print()
```

```

# 6. Print written observation explicitly
print("=== FORMAL OBSERVATIONS ===")
print("1. Positivity of R_ii:")
print("    Every diagonal element of R is strictly positive ( $R_{ii} > 0$ ). In")
print(f"    {'', '.join([f'{{x:.6f}}' for x in diag_R])}")
print("2. Geometric Interpretation:")
print("    The diagonal element  $R_{ii} = ||v_i||_2$  is the Euclidean norm of")
print("    which is the orthogonal component of column  $a_i$  that remains af")
print("    span of the first  $i-1$  columns. Geometrically, it represents the")
print("    from the vector  $a_i$  to the subspace spanned by the preceding co")
print("    of A are linearly independent,  $a_i$  can never lie in the span of")
print("    so  $v_i \neq 0$ , ensuring its norm  $R_{ii}$  is strictly positive.")

```

```

--- Random Matrix A (7 x 5) ---
[ 0.6891 -0.0477 1.3020 -1.8742 1.2322 ]
[ 0.2625 -0.8095 -1.8132 1.9625 -1.9727 ]
[ 1.0792 0.9871 -0.4902 -0.0234 1.7158 ]
[ -0.4182 1.8958 0.0977 -1.6255 1.2532 ]
[ -1.1533 0.2174 -0.8309 1.2646 1.3122 ]
[ -1.1137 0.5793 -1.6193 -0.3533 -1.6125 ]
[ -1.4240 -1.1512 -0.0934 -1.6895 -1.0598 ]

```

```

--- Orthogonal Matrix Q (7 x 5) ---
[ 0.2707 -0.0495 0.3701 -0.4288 0.2988 ]
[ 0.1031 -0.3214 -0.7187 -0.1156 -0.0172 ]
[ 0.4239 0.3283 -0.3380 -0.2999 0.5676 ]
[ -0.1643 0.7438 0.1253 -0.1741 -0.1118 ]
[ -0.4530 0.1355 -0.1216 0.5131 0.6480 ]
[ -0.4375 0.2721 -0.4135 -0.3677 -0.2684 ]
[ -0.5593 -0.3754 0.1755 -0.5330 0.2895 ]

```

```

--- Upper Triangular Matrix R (5 x 5) ---
[ 2.5458 0.3026 1.0786 0.4788 1.3554 ]
[ 0.0000 2.6158 -0.0882 -1.0451 2.2053 ]
[ 0.0000 0.0000 2.7171 -2.6040 1.7720 ]
[ 0.0000 0.0000 0.0000 2.5462 0.7979 ]
[ 0.0000 0.0000 0.0000 0.0000 2.2120 ]

```

=== DIAGONAL ELEMENTS OF R ===

```

R_11 = 2.545822
R_22 = 2.615843
R_33 = 2.717125
R_44 = 2.546212
R_55 = 2.211966

```

```

Reconstruction Error ||A - Q*R||_F = 6.8439e-16
Orthogonality Error ||Q^T*Q - I||_F = 5.5233e-16

```

=== FORMAL OBSERVATIONS ===

1. Positivity of R_{ii} :

Every diagonal element of R is strictly positive ($R_{ii} > 0$). In this run, the values are:

2.545822, 2.615843, 2.717125, 2.546212, 2.211966

2. Geometric Interpretation:

The diagonal element $R_{ii} = ||v_i||_2$ is the Euclidean norm of the residual vector v_i ,

which is the orthogonal component of column a_i that remains after projecting it onto the

span of the first $i-1$ columns. Geometrically, it represents the perpendicular distance

from the vector a_i to the subspace spanned by the preceding columns. Because the columns

of A are linearly independent, a_i can never lie in the span of the preceding columns,

so $v_i \neq 0$, ensuring its norm R_{ii} is strictly positive.